SCHWA IN THREE-SYLLABLE WORDS

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Three syllables means three claps and only one strong clap. Check the box under the stressed syllable, then underline every vowel letter that says the lazy "uh" in the two weak syllables. Some of these words have two schwas, so count them and write the number in the last box.

1.	ba · nan · a	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
2.	pres · i · dent	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
3.	el · e · phant	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
4.	Can · a · da	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
5.	tel · e · phone	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
6.	al · pha · bet	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
7.	buf · fa · lo	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
8.	par · a · graph	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
9.	di · no · saur	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	
10.	cel · e · brate	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	

The pattern: the middle syllable of a three-syllable word is the one most likely to be reduced. That is why telephone, alphabet, paragraph and celebrate all carry a vowel letter nobody really pronounces.

For non-commercial, education use only

SCHWA IN THREE-SYLLABLE WORDS

ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Three syllables means three claps and only one strong clap. Check the box under the stressed syllable, then underline every vowel letter that says the lazy "uh" in the two weak syllables. Some of these words have two schwas, so count them and write the number in the last box.

1.	ba · 'nan · a	☐ 1	☑ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	2
2.	'pres · i · dent	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	1
3.	'el · e · phant	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	2
4.	'Can · a · da	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	2
5.	'tel · e · phone	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	1
6.	'al · pha · bet	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	1
7.	'buf · fa · lo	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	1
8.	'par · a · graph	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	1
9.	'di · no · saur	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	1
10.	'cel · e · brate	☑ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	how many schwas?	1

The pattern: the middle syllable of a three-syllable word is the one most likely to be reduced. That is why telephone, alphabet, paragraph and celebrate all carry a vowel letter nobody really pronounces.